ABU DHABI ALDAR CHAMPIONSHIP · YAS LINKS · FINAL · PAR 72

The field vs the house rules

68 players · 272 rounds · house rules v18.1

WINNER	TOP 10	11TH ON
−23	68.04	70.87
Rahm · 265	a round · 12 others	a round · 55

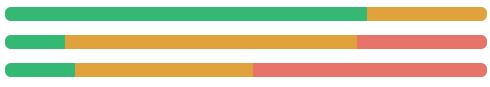
THE READ

The top 10 hit no more fairways than the rest — both 66%. They out-scored them with greens from the fairway and the hole after a bogey.

Greens from the fairway 92% against 85% · bogey or worse after a bogey 11% against 20% · HIGH-stress rounds 27% against 49% · holed inside 6 ft 93.3% against 92.6%: the short putter did not separate them. The winner: every par 5 on in three (16/16), no bogey after a bogey (0/5), never over par after six holes.

The shots to coach: from the fairway, the green is the target; every par 5 is planned on in three; after a bogey, the fairway club and the middle of the green.

RULE 05 · STRESS LEVEL BY ROUND · LOW · MEDIUM · HIGH



STROKES BETTER (+) OR WORSE (−) THAN THE FIELD'S AVERAGE, BY LEVEL · THE 67 OTHERS

LOW · 38 RDS	MEDIUM · 110 RDS	HIGH · 120 RDS
+2.83	+0.97	−2.00

RULE	MEASURED AS	RAHM	TOP 10	11TH ON	TOUR W · F
THE FIVE NON-NEGOTIABLES					
01 Lay back and you hit the fairway	Lay-back tee shots in the fairway (winner: clubs from his bag; field not measured, no clubs)	80% (20/25)	–	–	
02 Wedges always find the green	Wedge shots on the green (every shot from 150 yd in)	93%	89%	85%	
	Full shots, 40–150 yd	88%	87%	80%	
	Chips, pitches and bunker shots, under 40 yd	100%	91%	92%	
	Rounds with every one on the green	25%	31%	18%	
03 Never leave 40–74 yards	Leaves in 40–74 yd a round	1.25	1.54	1.33	
04 Carry by 15, or lay back by 15	Not measured: no hazard lines in the tour file	–	–	–	
05 Choose to play stress free	Rounds graded HIGH stress	0%	27%	49%	
HOUSE RULES, RANKED (V18.1)					
1 Inside 6 feet is sacred	Holed inside 6 ft	94%	93%	93%	
	Holed from 3–6 ft	78%	77%	76%	90% · 84%
2 Every par 5 on the green in three, with the go line	Par 5s on the green in 3 or fewer	100%	91%	86%	90% · 83%
3 Approach inside 40 feet	Regulation approaches on the green, under 40 ft	80%	73%	65%	
4 Beyond 24 feet, the target is the leave	First putts from 24 ft and out, left within 10%	88%	83%	81%	
5 Short game finishes inside 6 feet	Chips and bunker shots finishing inside 6 ft	50%	48%	46%	
6 Never escape a bad lie with a driver or fairway wood	Bad lies played with a driver or wood (winner: from his bag; field not measured)	0 of 4	–	–	
7 Own one band	Not measured: a practice rule (the one band to work on)	–	–	–	
8 Birdie conversion	Birdie or better, of greens hit	44%	38%	30%	42% · 33%
9 The reset hole	Bogey or worse after a bogey	0%	11%	20%	4% · 19%
10 A par-5 lay-up stays in the fairway, as close as it allows	Par-5 lay-ups in the fairway	50%	52%	45%	
HOUSE STATS AND MISTAKES					
Clutch Factor Ball Striking	Par or better after trouble	25%	65%	53%	85% · 62%
Clutch Factor Putting	Par-saving putts from 5 ft+ holed	40%	43%	37%	58% · 45%
Clutch Factor Response	No bogey in the 3 holes after one	60%	71%	54%	81% · 56%
Clutch Factor Damage Control	Trouble held to bogey or better	100%	91%	85%	98.5% · 88.5%
Mistakes	Bogeys or worse a round	1.25	1.69	2.72	1.4 · 2.6
	Doubles or worse a round	0.00	0.21	0.39	

Data = DP World Tour shot-by-shot feed (Event Centre), every player, every round, every hole: 280 rounds and 19,680 shots in the feed (272 counted here, the 68 players with four graded rounds), every round reconciled to its official card on all 18 holes · graded by the RC Greenlight engine at house rules v18.1 (Rev 362: the DP World reader, metrics.js, nn-grade, the Raw builder's ladder) · **68 players with four graded rounds** (Calum Hill R1 and Kristoffer Reitan R4 each have a tee shot with no position, so neither week is counted) · groups: Rahm · the 12 others who finished T10 or better · the 55 who finished 11th or worse · tint = the top 10 better (green) or worse (amber) than 11th on by 5 points or more, 0.25 a round on counts · **tour column** = RC Greenlight tour shot study, 2026 season (35 winners, 313 others, PGA TOUR), W = winners · F = field, beside ours, never a standard · **read by the RC Greenlight reader (Rev 362), no patch:** the feed's DoubleBogeyOrWorse takes the card's par; a stroke-and-distance row ends on the tee; a water ball's drop row is the penalty stroke; a penalty with no position leaves the ball where it lies (McIlroy R1 H12: his two-shot Rule 8.1b penalty, an 8 on the card); OWA, OBU, ODO, OUK and OTF read Other (owner, 2026-11-08) · a lone ball the feed flags provisional is the ball played · **rule 02 read literally** (owner 2026-11-09): with no clubs in the feed, every shot from 150 yd and in, off the green, is a wedge shot and must finish on the green · **RULES READ LITERALLY** (owner 2026-11-09: each rule's own measure, nothing standing in) · NOT MEASURED, no clubs, pins or hazard lines in the feed: rule 01 and rule 6 for the field (the winner's come from his published stock yardages), rule 04, front pin (11), the long side / open side (12), The Check, the go line and the short par 4; rule 7 is a practice rule (the one band to work on) · rule 05 levels are the engine's, by round, never averaged.

Jon Rahm vs the house rules

4 ROUNDS
DISTANCES IN YARDS · PUTTING IN FEET

THE READ

Lay-backs 20 of 25 in the fairway; wedge shots 33 of 35 on the green (clubs read from the bag). Next to master: Never leave 40–74 yards (R2, R3, R4).

The decision: Don't plan a shot that leaves 40–74 yards. Leave a distance you hit greens from, full wedge or three-quarter.

RULE 05 · R1	RULE 05 · R2	RULE 05 · R3	RULE 05 · R4
LOW	MEDIUM	LOW	LOW

RULE	MEASURED AS	R1	R2	R3	R4	WEEK
THE FIVE NON-NEGOTIABLES						
01 Lay back and you hit the fairway	The grade	Broken	Broken	Broken	Broken	
	Lay-back tee shots in the fairway	7/8	4/6	4/5	5/6	**80%** 20/25
02 Wedges always find the green	The grade	Broken	Kept	Broken	Kept	
	Wedge shots on the green	8/9	7/7	10/11	8/8	**94%** 33/35
	Full wedges (40 yd+)	4/5	2/2	7/8	6/6	**90%** 19/21
	Chips, pitches and bunker shots	4/4	5/5	3/3	2/2	**100%** 14/14
03 Never leave 40–74 yards	The grade	Kept	Attention	Attention	Attention	
	Leaves in 40–74 yd	0	1	2	2	**5**
04 Carry by 15, or lay back by 15	Carries and lay-backs by 15 yards	not measured · not measured · no hazard lines in the files				
05 Choose to play stress free	Stress level	LOW	MEDIUM	LOW	LOW	
HOUSE RULES, RANKED (V18.1)						
1 Inside 6 feet is sacred	Holed inside 6 ft	15/17	14/15	14/15	16/16	**94%** 59/63
	Holed from 3–6 ft	3/5	3/4	3/4	5/5	**78%** 14/18
2 Every par 5 on the green in three, with the go line	Par 5s on the green in 3 or fewer	4/4	4/4	4/4	4/4	**100%** 16/16
3 Approach inside 40 feet	Regulation approaches on the green, under 40 ft	15/18	12/17	15/18	15/18	**80%** 57/71
4 Beyond 24 feet, the target is the leave	First putts from 24 ft and out, left within 10%	5/5	5/6	5/6	6/7	**88%** 21/24
5 Short game finishes inside 6 feet	Chips and bunker shots finishing inside 6 ft	4/4	2/6	1/3	1/3	**50%** 8/16
6 Never escape a bad lie with a driver or fairway wood	Bad lies played with a driver or wood	0/1	0/1	–	0/2	**0%** 0/4
7 Own one band	The one band to work on	not measured · not measured · a practice rule				
8 Birdie conversion	Birdie or better, of greens hit	7/16	8/14	6/16	6/16	**44%** 27/62
9 The reset hole	Bogey or worse after a bogey	–	0/3	0/1	0/1	**0%** 0/5
10 A par-5 lay-up stays in the fairway, as close as it allows	Par-5 lay-ups in the fairway	3/3	0/2	2/2	0/3	**50%** 5/10
11 Front pin: play at least 5 yards past it	Approaches to a front pin	not measured · no pin positions in the files				
12 Miss on the long side / open side	Misses on the long side / open side	not measured · no pin positions in the files				
HOUSE STATS AND MISTAKES						
Clutch Factor Ball Striking	Par or better after trouble	1/1	0/2	–	0/1	**25%** 1/4
Clutch Factor Putting	Par-saving putts from 5 ft+ holed	1/1	1/2	0/1	0/1	**40%** 2/5
Clutch Factor Response	No bogey in the 3 holes after one	–	1/3	1/1	1/1	**60%** 3/5
Clutch Factor Damage Control	Trouble held to bogey or better	1/1	2/2	–	1/1	**100%** 4/4
Mistakes	Bogeys or worse	0	3	1	1	**5**
	Doubles or worse	0	0	0	0	**0**

Counted from each round's graded shot table, the same table its Raw sheet was graded from, by the RC Greenlight engine (summary-rules-v1 (2026-11-16)); rule names and wording are the house rules' own · the grade = each non-negotiable graded on the round's shot table by today's house rules (house-rules-v18.1), which can differ from an older Raw sheet; rule 05 levels by round, never averaged · Week = the rounds counted, added together · R1–R4: read from the DP World Tour shot file by the house reader, every hole adding up to the official card (65, 67, 66, 67 = 265) · playing order from hole 1 where the round gave no start hole · not measured: approaches to a front pin and the long side / open side (no pin positions in the files) · Jon Rahm alone (no one else in the field has a bag on file, so rules 01–02 are not compared with the field): clubs are not in the tour shot file, so each was read from his published stock yardages (ProYardages totals after Golf Monthly, its GW/SW/LW estimated; Golf Monthly carries for 5-wood, 2-iron, 4-iron) — the most likely club, rules 01–02 graded literally: one miss is Broken